

The Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of Samantabhadra, together with the Dhāraṇī-Mantra

Ārya-samantabhadra-nāmāṣṭaśataka-dhāraṇī-mantra-sahita · Toh 877 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་ཀུན་དབྱུང་པའི་མཆོད་བརྟན་ལྷ་པ་གཟུགས་སྒྲས་དང་བཅས་པ།

The Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of Samantabhadra, together with the Dhāraṇī-Mantra, known in Tibetan by a title beginning "Phakpa Kuntu Zangpo," the Noble Samantabhadra, and corresponding to a Sanskrit title along the lines of Ārya Samantabhadra Nāmāṣṭaśataka, is a short devotional and incantatory work centered on the great bodhisattva Samantabhadra, whose name means "All-Good." It opens with an homage praising his great compassion, his clear realization of the Dharma, his nature as vast as space, and his manifold forms. It then relates how Samantabhadra enters a bodhisattva meditative absorption, setting the stage for the recitation of his one hundred and eight names and an accompanying dhāraṇī-mantra, a sacred formula valued for recitation and spiritual protection. The text is Toh 877 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī and name-litany texts associated with the tantric section of the canon.

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Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being Samantabhadra, who is endowed with great compassion; who has attained the clear illumination of the Dharma, whose essential nature is equal to the whole of the vast expanse of space without remainder; who has attained an undivided body that radiates throughout the sphere of the earth, and the equality of the bodies of the three times; who has manifold forms; who is supreme among bodhisattva great beings and gives what is most excellent and sublime; whose body of great qualities holds sway over all the grounds.

Then at that time the supreme great bodhisattva Samantabhadra, he of manifold forms, entered into the meditative absorption of the bodhisattvas called the Great Lord of the All-Pervading Grounds.

The very moment the bodhisattva, the great being Samantabhadra, entered into that absorption, bodies as numerous as the atoms in the particles of a great thousandfold world system spread out fully in every direction, and these bodies, contained within the element of space, came to be stationed

throughout many spheres of the earth.

Then the tathāgatas within all the infinite buddha fields stretched out their right hands, stroked the head of the bodhisattva, the great being Samantabhadra, and said, "Excellent, excellent, son of noble family! Speak the great dhāraṇī that is the essence of every source of buddhas!"

Then the supreme bodhisattva great being made his body shine with a hundred thousand rays of light, and by this he made all the buddha fields shake at that time. Then he spoke this dhāraṇī:

tadyathā oṃ namo namastri bhuvaneśvare mahābhogāya asamasama
amitasama anantasama gaganasama tribhuvanasama aśeṣasama veṣasama
parama arthasama svabhāvasama tathātāsama arajaḥsma śuddhisama
buddhisama dharmatathātāsama abhiṣamasama samasama ekānāya sāgara
viśuddhe āloka hī hī labdha labdha vijaya vijaya oṃ prasagata naya naya
hinira adhiṣṭhāna saṃbhoga aṃ analaya laya dharma agra dhara dhara jaya
jaya hūṃ hūṃ dhama dhama svāhā

Then the eldest of the Victor's children, the sole protector of all the worlds, who wishes to benefit all sentient beings, the bodhisattva Samantabhadra, looked into the face of the Blessed One, made the sphere of the earth shake, and spoke these words, filling the three worlds completely.

Then, from the maṇḍala filled with great bodhisattvas together with gods and asuras, one whose body was adorned with blazing, shining golden rays of light and with mighty tremors moved from the great vajra-flower seat that spans the whole surface of the earth, rose up from the maṇḍala, let out the sound "Ha ha!", and said:

"Ah, great dhāraṇī, vast and all-pervading ocean of great compassion and of countless qualities! Ah, great source of buddhas, equal to the three realms that have neither end nor center, abiding in order to bring countless realms of sentient beings to full ripening, great dhāraṇī of the maṇḍala of Dharma that has no abiding! Ah, great dhāraṇī that clears away the habitual tendencies of evil cast forward from endless eons, dries up the ocean of afflictions, and scatters the mountain of views!

"Anyone who has not truly gathered, over endless eons, a store of roots of virtue, who has not cultivated the seed of awakening by seeing many hundreds of thousands of sugatas face to face, and who has not attained the complete ocean of the distinctive qualities of the ground of omniscience,

anyone other than this cannot even hear this great dhāraṇī, the essence of all the tathāgatas; what need is there to speak of holding it, reading it, or fully mastering it? Even the mere name of this great dhāraṇī is hard to hear in a thousand times ten million eons.

"Ah, those sentient beings in whose hands this great dhāraṇī rests have gained a good gain. They live a good life. They are a good basis for the higher knowledges. Their roots of virtue are perfectly complete. They abide in the domain of the tathāgatas. All their qualities are perfectly complete.

"By merely reciting it once, one will be freed from all the sufferings of the lower realms. By merely reciting it twice, one will be released from all evil. By merely reciting it three times, one will be released from all afflictions. Thus, by mere recitation one attains qualities higher and higher, and one will also see the Tathāgata.

"If one recites it while walking back and forth, one will be freed from all suffering. If one recites it at the foot of a solitary tree, one will obtain all accomplishments. If one recites it while traveling, all sentient beings will come under one's power. If one sits cross-legged in a great forest and recites it seven times, one will attain great meditative concentration and will also be free of afflictions.

"Sitting cross-legged before an image of noble Samantabhadra, one should make offerings of as many flowers and other things as one can, and recite this great dhāraṇī until the body grows tired. If, once rested, one lies down right there, one will see the bodhisattva Samantabhadra in a dream. With his right hand he strokes that person and fully comforts him, and he also bestows the great light of the Dharma. He also says, 'Excellent, excellent, child of the Victor! You have entered the great maṇḍala of the Tathāgata. When you have passed from this life, you will attain the great ground.' Then one will wake up endowed with ease of body, ease of mind, great joy, serene faith, and supreme great delight. One will also become renowned for great power and great might. The gods too will come to see that person.

"Rising in the morning, one should read the sūtras compiled by the bodhisattvas. One should also generate a mind intent on the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings. Then all the perfections will be brought to completion, one will be free of all evil, the forces of affliction will be vanquished, and one will be praised even by the tathāgatas.

"The gods and others will also strive to guard, protect, and shelter that person. That child of the Victors who acts in this way, just as taught, will before long enter the great ground of Samantabhadra."

Then all who had gathered in the great maṇḍala rose. There were Vajroṣṇīṣa and the other great vidyādharaś, lords of the trichilocosm; Mahālocanā and the other great female vidyādharaś; Vajragarbha and the other bodhisattva great beings; Vajrapāśa and the other great gods of the vidyā-mantras; Ratnajālīnī and the other great goddesses of the vidyā-mantras; the goddess Tārā and the other deities of the great bodhisattva's maṇḍala; the youths Great Silk, Surūpa, Most Lovely to Behold, and others; the maidens, the servants, and the brahmin women; Akṣobhya and the other great vināyakaś; Supreme Body and the other lords of the rākṣaśaś; the mātṛkāś and the other rākṣaśīś; Maheśvara and the other lords of the gods; and Vajra Flower Crown and all the others, the bodhisattvaś and so on, assembled in the great maṇḍala. They praised the supreme among great bodhisattvaś, noble Samantabhadra, with the hundred and eight names called "The Light of Unsurpassed Qualities":

Samantabhadra, supreme of all,
Great in the riches of every variety,
Great maṇḍala, supreme vajra,
Of manifold forms, lord of the directions.

Great vajra, of great delight,
Of great splendor, mighty in strength,
Subduer and great subduer, foremost in glory,
All-pervading lord, king of the Victors' intelligence.

Great vajra, laughing broadly,
Accomplisher of the great and hard to accomplish,
Sporting with great music,
Of great joy, the tamer.

The Great God, Maheśvara,
The mighty one, Viṣṇu, lord of beings,
Delighting above the earth, beneath the earth, and on the earth,
Likewise holder of the earth, of the three worlds.

Method in the sequence of discipline and giving,
Lord of a thousand who knows perfectly,
Possessed of knowledge, delighting in patience,

Source of diligence, of great riches.

Of tenfold diligence and tenfold means,
Great son and eldest of the One with the Ten Powers,
Inspired by a thousand powers of might,
Fully endowed, dispeller of the ten.

Dispeller of dust, great king,
King, an ocean of maṇḍalas,
Means for fully pacifying all dust,
Knowing the rites, possessed of intelligence.

Learned, beautiful, of good fortune,
Most lovely, generating joy,
Glory arisen from the great essence,
Free of afflictions, hard to overcome.

Equal to the earth, equal to the sky,
Whose domain is like the wind,
Splendor itself, equal to splendor,
Like the waters of the four oceans.

Pacifier of torpor and madness,
Crusher of afflictions hard to overcome,
Dispeller of battle, delighting in battle,
Destroyer of the evils of battle.

Of excellent speech, laughing with the voice of a swan,
Indra, Upendra, son of Mahendra,
Surpassing Indra, equal to the Sage,
Holder of the Dharma, shown as endowed with riches.

Pacifier of the haze of elation,
Drier of the mire of afflictions,
Hero dispelling the fever of pride,
Crusher of the arrogance of the wrathful.

Endowed with sweet and gentle speech,
Equal, equal to the unequal,
Gone beyond the domain of the unequaled,
Sharing one domain with all the buddhas.

Sporting vastly at the seat of awakening,
Virtuous one who fully teaches the stages,
Virtuous, perfect in excellent eyes,
Pure one, giver of the excellent path.

Purifier, supreme giver of the fire offering,
Destroyer who utterly crushes obstructors,
Bestower of attainment, speaker beyond compare,
Sole light of the vajra world.

Lord of the hosts of men and women,
Who surely brings the riches of qualities,
Pacifier of the saṃsāra of sentient beings,
Steadfast one, free of all evils.

Illuminator, victorious everywhere,
Having the maṇḍala of the all-victorious,
Bringing the light of an ocean everywhere,
Dispeller of faults everywhere.

Stirring up the dreadful underworld,
Likewise bringing exhaustion and an end,
Churning the ocean of afflictions,
Exhausting the forces of affliction.

Radiating blazing austerity,
Pacifier of pride and swelling arrogance,
Great vajra, producer of strength,
Surely crushing all hostility.

Abiding beyond, dispeller of evil,
Whose domain is the pure sky,
Giving purity and giving qualities,
Giving results and giving all.

Giving wisdom and giving merit,
Giving enjoyments and giving victory,
Giving sovereignty and giving speech,
Giving wealth, rich in hosts, vajra-holder.

Giving form, hero, fully victorious,
Giving the way of purity and virtue,
Source of bliss, bearing a jewel on the crown,

Holder of the earth, hard to grasp.

Accomplisher of the maṇḍala's delight,
Descending and likewise causing descent,
Net of jewels, equal to jewels,
Lamp dispelling darkness, possessed of victory.

Endowed with qualities, wisdom, and the Great Vehicle,
Supreme in steadfastness, of great dharmatā,
Great speaker, of great wisdom,
Fully teaching the way of the buddhas.

Great offering, of the Great Vehicle,
Endowed with the unsurpassed vehicle,
Knowing the Dharma of great offering,
Great fruit, supreme Dharma.

Revealer, tamer, the Teacher,
Peaceful and likewise bringing peace,
Good, and like the good,
Clearing away everywhere, throughout the infinite expanse.

Knowing the essence of compassion and wisdom,
Having a maṇḍala of the light of compassion,
Perfectly complete in great compassion,
Purifier of the great occasion.

Supreme lake, clear and lofty,
Whose domain is beyond great disputes,
Protector of beings, wide-eyed,
Possessed of riches hard to find,

Acting everywhere, virtuous within,
Giver of sublime joy.

Possessing every domain, everywhere,
Forever endowed with excellence,
Tamed, the equal of all buddhas,
You are the lotus of the great maṇḍala,
The means that soothes and cools like the moon,
Wise, free of pride, knowing the rites,
Abiding in a single sphere of activity,

Possessing the wisdom of the Tathāgatas,
Knowing that very great commitment,
Great master of great renown,
Sublime and unsurpassed,
You make the waves of secret mantra spread far and wide.

Thus the great all-pervading lord,
Rich with the fragrance of a hundred qualities,
Pure, refined, wise, and so forth,
Source of qualities, king of vidyā-mantras,
Bearer of a jewel on his crown, and so forth,
Was praised with these supreme names, and then
The Blessed One, who has destroyed the river of suffering,
Spoke these words:

"Oh! These hundred great praises,
The hundred and eight names, are sublime.
Whoever among human beings
Praises from the heart with these
Samantabhadra, who clears away evil,
Will attain even buddhahood itself.
Whoever recites the hundred and eight names,
That person will be perfect in qualities
And able to speak, without remainder,
The wisdom of the great way of the Tathāgata."

Thus the son of the Supreme Sage, who has surely arisen from the fragrance
of a hundred qualities,
Source of manifold qualities, whose qualities are extolled by the world and by
those beyond it:
If one praises every day, with this praise, the son of the Victors made radiant
by great praise,
One will become the embodiment of the One with the Ten Powers and gain
radiance, and will become a source of pure qualities.

The Hundred and Eight Names of Noble Samantabhadra, together with the
Dhāraṇī-Mantra, is complete.

Translator's Notes

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.